A-A-20033A
January 10, 1986
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20033
February 18, 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TEA, BLACK (BAGS OR LOOSE)

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Federal Specification HHH-T-191.

Salient characteristics.

Black tea shall be fully fermented, dry, uniform in color, clean, sound, and practically free from sticks, stems, and stalks. The leaf size for bulk tea shall be pekoe, orange pekoe, broken pekoe, broken orange pekoe, broken tea, or a blend of these, but fannings or dust shall be excluded. The leaf size for bag tea shall be the same as for bulk tea, except that the fannings may be included. The aroma from the dry tea shall be sweet, fresh, and free from obnoxious or foreign odors. The dry leaf shall have a good appearance (including twist). The infused leaf shall be bright, uniform in color and possess a sweet, fresh odor. The prepared tea beverage shall have a color typical of that produced by black tea. Black tea from recognized tea producing countries, either singularly or blended, shall produce a tea of pleasing flavor and shall be fully equal in cup quality when compared to the current Standard A-2 of the Tea Association of America.

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and finished product requirements of this Commercial Item Description (CID). The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. The delivered product shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

AMSC N/A

FSC 8955

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Quality assurance.

When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the quality assurance of the tea shall be determined by the Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, U.S. Department of Agriculture. The product shall be examined and/or tested in accordance with the applicable provisions in the CID and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation and in accordance with the requirements in the applicable regulations.

Examination of packaging.

Classification of defects found during examinations shall be in accordance with Tables II through V. Sampling plans and acceptance criteria shall be in accordance with Table I. Acceptable quality levels (AQL's) shall be expressed as defects per hundred units for Tables II and V and as percent defective for Tables III and IV. Sampling for finished products and packaging examination shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

TABLE I. Packaging examination criteria

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQL's	
				Major	Minor
II	I	1 filled and closed intermediate box	Intermediate boxes	1.0	2.5
III	S-3	1 filled intermediate box or 10 bags from a box	Intermediate boxes	---	2.5
IV	S-3	1 filled intermediate box	Intermediate boxes	---	2.5
V	S-4	Ten bags from an intermediate box	Intermediate boxes	2.5	---

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TABLE II. Examination of intermediate box

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Hole, tear, or sifter
102		Not closed
103		Hole or tear in overwrap or overwrap missing (when applicable)
104		Carton liner or polyethylene bag missing or not completely separating product from box (when applicable)
	201	Not clean (dirty, stained or smeared)
105		Label missing (as applicable)

TABLE III. Examination for net weight 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Net weight of 1 pound box is less than 15.2 ounces or 1/2 pound box is less than 7.6 ounces.
202	Net weight of 10 bags is more than 5 percent under required net weight.

1/ Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicate a lot average net weight is less than required net weight.

2/ Report results as follows - Bags (2.27 gm) to nearest 0.1 gram; bulk and 1 ounce packaged product to nearest 0.1 ounce.

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TABLE IV. Examination for count of tea bags 1/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	More than 5 percent (to nearest unit) under specified count.

1/ Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicate a lot average count less than the specified count.

TABLE V. Examination of tea bag

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Tear, hole, or opening in bag causing contents to sift out.
102	Bag string (when applicable) missing or not attached.
103	String tag (when applicable) missing or not attached.

Product examination.

The finished product shall be evaluated for conformance to the salient characteristics. The sample unit shall be 2 ounces of tea extracted from 1 unit container, except for tea bags, in which case it shall be the number of tea bags from 1 container necessary to yield 2 ounces of tea. Eight samples of 2 ounces each shall be randomly selected from the lot and contents examined for conformance with requirements stated in the salient characteristics. Lot shall be rejected if one or more sample units fail to conform to the salient characteristics.

Examination for foreign material.

Examination of the finished product shall be made to determine the presence of foreign material (e.g., metal, glass, evidence of insect, bird and rodent contamination, etc.). The sample unit for examination shall be 4 ounces of loose tea extracted from a primary container, or in the case of tea bags, the number of tea bags necessary to yield 4 ounces of tea. The sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-3. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of pounds. Sample units shall be taken from the same

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containers that are sampled for product examination. Lot shall be rejected if one or more sample units show the presence of foreign material.

Test for extraneous materials.

For determination of excessive adulteration of tea, the following test method of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists shall be run on any sample unit found to be questionable by the USDA inspector. Any sample exceeding 1 percent extraneous material shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

Test	Chapter	Method
Filth in Ground Coffee and Substitutes	Extraneous Materials	Sedimentation and Flotation Method

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The tea shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice and as stated in 1 or 2 below. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the contract or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

1. Eight-hundredths of an ounce (0.08 ounce) of product shall be packaged in a commerical tea bag, with tag and string, individually wrapped (envelope pack). One hundred 0.08-ounce (2.27-gram) bags shall be packaged in a lined intermediate box in accordance with commercial practice. The box shall or shall not be overwrapped.

2. One ounce of product shall be packaged in a commercial tea bag, either with or without tag and string. Twenty-four or forty-eight 1-ounce bags shall be overpackaged in accordance with good commercial practice.

For Department of Defense procurements.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer:

A. Commercial packaging.

1. Bags. Eight-hundredths of an ounce (0.08 ounce) of product shall be packaged in a commercial tea bag, with tag and string. One hundred 0.08-ounce (2.27-gram) bags shall be packaged in an intermediate box in accordance with good commercial practice. The box shall be overwrapped.

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2. Bulk. One-half pound or 1-pound of bulk tea shall be packaged in a lined intermediate box in accordance with good commercial practice. Alternatively, unlined boxes may be used when the tea is unit packed 1/2 pound or 1 pound in polyethylene bags prior to packaging in commercial boxes. The 1 pound box may contain one 1-pound bag or two 1/2-pound bags of bulk tea. All boxes shall be overwrapped.

B. Commercial packing.

1. Bags. Ten, twelve, or twenty-four intermediate boxes of tea bags shall be packed in fiberboard containers complying with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the closures of fiberboard boxes.

2. Bulk. Forty-eight 1/2-pound boxes or twenty-four 1-pound boxes of bulk tea shall be packed in fiberboard containers complying with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the closures of fiberboard boxes.

C. Export packing. One shipping container of product, commercially packaged and packed, as specified above, shall be overpacked in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with Style RSC, Grade W5c or W5s of PPP-B-636. Prior to overpacking, the box shall be enclosed in a waterproof case liner, fabricated and sealed in accordance with MIL-L-10547 for subsistence items. The case liner shall be protected from damage by covering all exposed metal fasteners on the boxes with pressure-sensitive tape or paperboard pads. Reinforcement shall be restricted to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

D. Commercial unit loads. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with Type III, Class G of MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

E. Export unit loads. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with Type I, Class A of MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

F. Labeling (commercial and export). Labeling of interior packages shall be in accordance with good commercial practice.

G. Marking of shipping containers (commercial and export). Commercial markings for shipping containers are acceptable provided the following information is included:

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National Stock Number
Item Description
Quantity, Unit of Issue
Date of Packaging (month/year)
Contract Number
Name, Address, and Zip Code of Contractor
Inspection/Test Date

H. Marking of commercial and export unit loads. Commercial and export unit loads shall be marked on two adjacent sides with the following information:

National Stock Number
Item Description
Number of Containers per Load, Quantity per Container, Unit of Issue
Commercial or Export Unit Load (as applicable)
Date of Pack (month/year)
Inspection/Test Date
Contract Number or Purchase Order Number
Name, Address, and Zip Code of Contractor
Gross Weight (including pallet weight)
Cube

When the markings on one or more individual shipping containers are exposed on two adjacent sides of the unit load, a minimum 3- by 5-inch white label shall be applied on the same two adjacent sides of the load. The label shall be marked (letter size not less than 1/2 inch) with the following information:

Number of Containers per Load
Commercial or Export Unit Load (as applicable)
Gross Weight (including pallet weight)
Cube

Notes.

Sources of documents:

Sources of nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
1616 P Street, NW
Washington, DC 20036

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Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1106
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists may be obtained from:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists
1111 North 19th Street
Suite 210
Arlington, VA 22209

Copies of Standard A-2 of the Tea Association of the U.S.A., Inc., may be obtained from:

Tea Association of the U.S.A., Inc.
230 Park Avenue
New York, NY 10017

Sources of governmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Director
Market Research and Development Division
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Washington, DC 20250

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This three-volume set may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specification Unit (WFSIS)
Room 6039
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

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Military activities should submit request for copies of this CID to:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19120

Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this CID may be submitted to the U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center; ATTN: STRNC-ES; Natick, MA 01760-5014.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - MRD
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project No. 8955-0054

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